Arunachal Pradesh is 89,000 square kilometres in area. That is bigger than Taiwan.' He stopped and smiled at me, staring into my eyes. The stare told me that he had had enough of the subject. It sounded, for a moment, like he had the answer to why China had failed with India. On reflection, I was not so sure. Over various trips to China, I have had rather similar Chinese reactions: an unbending sense that the border is a problem because it is a problem and best not to ask too many questions.